coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1

Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

- ✓ Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs!
  Reading • 3 min
- ✓ Getting Started: How Does This Course Work?
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister Introduces the Course
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Marvin Heiferman on "Photography Changes Everything"
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Optional Discussion Forum Prompts
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2

One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ **Introduction to Module 1**
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Artistic Equivalents
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- ○ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- ○ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, III-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- ○ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Moon Phases
  Reading • 6 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3

Documents and the Documentary

Module 4

One and Another

Module 5

Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6

Pictures of People

Module 7

Ocean of Images

Introduction to Module 1

1:27 / 1:30 1x

One Subject, Many Perspectives

The moon is among photography's most enduring subjects. Artists, scientists, commercial photographers, and amateurs alike have long used all methods and technologies at their disposal to capture views of the moon that might not be perceived by the naked eye. In the nineteenth century, scientists sometimes worked around the limitations of available technology by photographing drawings or models of the moon that were based on observations through a telescope.

Today, even those parts of the moon that cannot be observed from Earth have been photographed. The manifold ways in which the moon has been recorded—from close up, with its cratered surface shown in vivid detail, to distant and glowing in a vast night sky—have not only increased scientific knowledge of our planet's closest neighbor, but also reflected the emotional pull it has always had on us. More recently, artists have critiqued the imperial gaze directed at outer space, making visible the ways in which the moon has often been depicted as a territory to colonize.

Learning Objectives

- Discover photography's roots in both art and science by observing the diverse ways the medium has been used across time to capture a single subject familiar to us all.
- Learn how technological advancements have influenced photographic depictions of the moon.
- Analyze the narratives of discovery conveyed by photographs of the moon and their omissions.

Go to next item ✓ Completed

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